

HELEN SHIYANG LU

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September 2026

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

University of British Columbia 2024 – present
Postdoctoral Research Fellow, School of Audiology and Speech Sciences
Supervisors: Dr. Alexis K. Black and Dr. Janet F. Werker
Killam Postdoctoral Research Fellow (2024 – 2026); SSHRC Postdoctoral Fellow (2026 – 2028)

EDUCATION

University of Southern California 2018 – 2024
Ph.D. in Psychology with a Minor in Quantitative Methods (2024)
M.A. in Psychology (2020)
Dissertation: *The Effects of Language Experience on Statistical Learning in Infants and Adults*
Supervisory committee: Dr. Toben H. Mintz (chair); Dr. Jason D. Zevin; Dr. Frank Manis; Dr. Elsi M. Kaiser; Dr. Scott P. Johnson

University of California, Los Angeles 2014 – 2018
B.A. in Psychology and Linguistics with a Specialization in Computing
Summa cum laude; Departmental Highest Distinction

PUBLICATIONS

- Lu, H.S., & Mintz, T.H. (2026). Second language learning facilitates non-adjacent dependency learning: Effects moderated by specific language. *Cognitive Science*, 50(5), e70221.
<https://doi.org/10.1111/cogs.70221>
- Lu, H.S., & Mintz, T.H. (2026). Task-dependent learning of non-adjacent dependencies: Success in a familiarity rating task versus failure in a two-alternative forced choice task. *Psychonomic Bulletin & Review*, 33(1), 12. <https://doi.org/10.3758/s13423-025-02824-0>
- Lu, H.S., Werker, J.F., & Black, A.K. (2025). Statistical word segmentation in unfamiliar speech. *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 47.
<https://escholarship.org/uc/item/0sz0q4p8>
- Kosie, J.E., Zettersten, M., ... Lu, H.S., ... Lew-Williams, C. (Stage 1 registered report; in-principle acceptance, March 2024). ManyBabies 5: A large-scale investigation of the proposed shift from familiarity preference to novelty preference in infant looking time. *Nature Human Behaviour*.
<https://dx.doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/ck3vd>
- Lu, H.S., & Mintz, T.H. (2023). Dynamic action and human agents facilitate learning of non-adjacent dependencies in visual sequences. *Cognitive Science*, 47(9), e13344.
<https://doi.org/10.1111/cogs.13344>
- Lu, H.S., & Mintz, T.H. (2021). Learning non-adjacent rules and non-adjacent dependencies from human actions in 9-month-old infants. *PLOS One*, 16(6), e0252959.
<https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0252959>

Lu, H.S., & Mintz, T.H. (2021). Dynamic action facilitates learning of non-adjacent dependencies in visual sequences. *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 43. <https://escholarship.org/uc/item/8bn7r4rp>

REFEREED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Lu, H.S., Black, A.K., & Werker, J.F. (2026, November; accepted). The impact of bilingualism on the developmental trajectory of vowel harmony sensitivity. Boston University Conference on Language Development (BUCLD 51), Boston, MA. [Poster]

Lu, H.S., Black, A.K., & Werker, J.F. (2026, July). Developmental changes in infants' sensitivity to vowel harmony for word segmentation. International Congress of Infant Studies (ICIS), Panama City, Panama. [Poster]

Lu, H.S., Black, A.K., & Werker, J.F. (2026, April). Do six-month-olds use vowel harmony to segment speech? Cognitive Development Society (CDS) Conference, Montreal, Canada. [Poster]

Lu, H.S., Werker, J.F., & Black, A.K. (2025, August). Statistical word segmentation in unfamiliar speech. Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci 2025), San Francisco, CA. [Talk]

Lu, H.S., Bokhanovich, O., & Mintz, T.H. (2025, May). How language experience shapes sensitivity to nonadjacent dependencies in 12-month-old infants. Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD) Biennial Meeting, Minneapolis, MN. [Poster] *Received Early Career Travel Award.*

Lu, H.S., & Mintz, T.H. (2024, June). Task-dependent learning outcomes: Successful non-adjacent dependency learning in a rating task but not in 2AFC. Interdisciplinary Advances in Statistical Learning, Donostia/San Sebastián, Spain. [Poster]

Lu, H.S., & Mintz, T.H. (2024, June). Non-adjacent dependency learning in monolingual and multilingual 12-month-olds: An online habituation study. Interdisciplinary Advances in Statistical Learning, Donostia/San Sebastián, Spain. [Poster]

Lu, H.S., & Mintz, T.H. (2024, March). Investigating non-adjacent dependency learning in 12-month-old infants. Cognitive Development Society (CDS) Conference, Pasadena, CA. [Poster]

Lu, H.S., & Mintz, T.H. (2023, March). Twelve-month-olds generalize nonadjacent dependencies from artificial speech presented at a natural speech rate. Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD) Biennial Meeting, Salt Lake City, UT. [Talk]

Lu, H.S., & Mintz, T.H. (2022, June). Human dynamic actions aid non-adjacent dependency learning in both infants and adults. Interdisciplinary Advances in Statistical Learning, Donostia/San Sebastián, Spain. [Talk]

Lu, H.S., & Mintz, T.H. (2021, July). Dynamic action facilitates learning of non-adjacent dependencies in visual sequences. 43rd Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, virtual. [Poster]

Lu, H.S., & Mintz, T.H. (2021, January). Learning non-adjacent rules and dependencies from human actions in 9-month-old infants: Actions sometimes speak louder than words. Budapest CEU Conference on Cognitive Development (BCCCD), virtual. [Talk]

Lu, H.S., & Mintz, T.H. (2019, October). Visual rule learning: The connection between human actions and speech. Cognitive Development Society (CDS) Conference, Louisville, KY. [Poster]

REGIONAL AND NON-REFEREED PRESENTATIONS

Lu, H.S., Werker, J.F., & Black, A.K. (2026, August). Longitudinal links between early word segmentation and later word recognition in monolingual and bilingual infants. Ensuring Full Literacy SSHRC Partnership Grant Annual Meeting, Vancouver, Canada. [Poster]

Lu, H.S., Werker, J.F., & Black, A.K. (2026, April). Cue weighting in monolingual and bilingual infants' word segmentation. UBC Language Sciences Postdoctoral & Graduate Research Day, Vancouver, Canada. [Talk]

Lu, H.S., Werker, J.F., & Black, A.K. (2026, March). Finding words in two languages: How bilingual experience shapes infant word learning. UBC Faculty of Medicine Building the Future Research Day, Vancouver, Canada. [Poster] *Awarded for Excellence in Research Communication.*

Lu, H.S., Werker, J.F., & Black, A.K. (2025, June). Segmenting words in two languages: Cue weighting of prosodic vs. statistical information in English and Cantonese. Ensuring Full Literacy SSHRC Partnership Grant Annual Meeting, Edmonton, Canada. [Poster]

Lu, H.S., & Mintz, T.H. (2019, May). Visual rule learning: The connection between human body movements and speech. 14th Annual Symposium on Cognitive and Language Development, Los Angeles, CA. [Talk]

Lu, H.S., Brady, S., Sanders, A., Johnson, S.P., & Sandhofer, C.M. (2018, May). What's in a word? The influence of productive vocabulary on toddlers' perceptual memory and shape bias. 27th Annual Psychology Undergraduate Research Conference, Los Angeles, CA. [Talk]

Lu, H.S., Brady, S., Sanders, A., Johnson, S.P., & Sandhofer, C.M. (2018, May). What's in a word? The relation of toddlers' productive vocabulary and feature memory. 13th Annual Symposium on Cognitive and Language Development, Irvine, CA. [Poster]

Lu, H.S., Sanders, A., & Johnson, S.P. (2017, May). Indexing working memory capacity in infancy. 12th Annual Symposium on Cognitive and Language Development, San Diego, CA. [Poster]

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

Lu, H.S., Bokhanovich, O., & Mintz, T.H. (in prep). Do twelve-month-old infants generalize linguistic non-adjacent dependencies? An online habituation study

Lu, H.S., Werker, J.F., & Black, A.K. (in prep). Segmenting words in two languages: Cue weighting of prosodic and statistical information in English and Cantonese.

FELLOWSHIPS

SSHRC Canada Postdoctoral Research Award	2026 – 2028
Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada, CAD \$70,000 per annum	

Killam Postdoctoral Research Fellowship	2024 – 2026
University of British Columbia, CAD \$60,000 per annum	

Frederick and Dorothy Quimby Memorial Scholarship	2023 – 2024
University of Southern California, USD \$22,750	

Dornsife PhD Fellowship	2019 – 2020; 2022 – 2023
University of Southern California, USD \$30,000 per annum	

GRANTS

Doctoral Dissertation Research Improvement Grant, Co-PI National Science Foundation (BCS-2234422), USD \$18,949 “Doctoral Dissertation Research: The Effects of Language Experience on Statistical Learning in Infants and Adults”	2023 – 2025
SSHRC Partnership Grant Co-applicant Fund, Collaborator “Full Literacy in a Multicultural and Digital World,” CAD \$10,000	2026
UBC Language Sciences Member Project Funding, Co-applicant University of British Columbia, CAD \$4,000	2026
USC Graduate School Summer Research and Writing Grant University of Southern California, USD \$5,000	2020
Department of Psychology Doctoral Research Grant Awards University of Southern California, USD \$3,200 (2020), \$1,600 (2022), \$1,365 (2023)	2020 – 2023
Department of Psychology Research Continuity Fund University of Southern California, USD \$945	2020

HONORS AND AWARDS

Excellence in Research Communication (Poster) UBC Faculty of Medicine Building the Future Research Trainee Day	2026
SRCD Early Career Travel Award Society for Research in Child Development, USD \$500	2025
Undergraduate Research Scholars Program University of California, Los Angeles, USD \$5,000	2017

INVITED TALKS

Department of Linguistics Colloquium, University of British Columbia (upcoming Oct)	2026
School of Audiology and Speech Sciences Colloquium, University of British Columbia	2026

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Sessional Instructor – Psychology of Language (PSYC 336) Department of Psychology, University of British Columbia Enrollment: 168 (2025); 183 (2026)	2025, 2026
Guest Lecturer – Infancy (PSYC 302) Department of Psychology, University of British Columbia Instructor of Record: Dr. Erica Flaten	2026
Teaching Assistant – Statistics I (PSYC 274) Department of Psychology, University of Southern California Instructor of Record: Dr. David Wash	2022
Teaching Assistant – Developmental Psychology (PSYC 336L) Department of Psychology, University of Southern California Instructor of Record: Dr. Frank Manis (2020); Dr. Leslie Berntsen (2021)	2020, 2021

Teaching Assistant – Experimental Research Methods (PSYC 314L)	2019
Department of Psychology, University of Southern California	
Instructor of Record: Dr. William Breland	
Teaching Assistant – Introduction to Psychology (PSYC 100)	2018
Department of Psychology, University of Southern California	
Instructor of Record: Dr. Ann Renken	

TEACHING TRAINING

Instructional Skills Workshop, University of British Columbia	2024
Future Faculty Training Workshop, University of Southern California	2020

RESEARCH MENTORSHIP

University of British Columbia

Grace Bu (directed studies student and undergrad RA)	2024 – 2025
Zoe Chung	2024 – Now
(undergrad RA; Multidisciplinary Research Program in Medicine mentee; now a grad RA and MSc student in SLP)	
Menna Zanger	2024 – Now
(undergrad RA; Work-Learn RA; Multidisciplinary Research Program in Medicine mentee; directed studies student)	
Jennifer Lin (undergrad RA; Work-Learn RA; now a grad RA and MSc student in SLP)	2024 – Now
Ashley Dulay (undergrad RA; Work-Learn RA)	2025 – Now
Queenie Zheng (undergrad RA)	2025 – Now
Cadence Chua (undergrad RA)	2026 – Now
Tiana Ho (undergrad RA)	2026 – Now
Crystal Basi (undergrad RA)	2026 – Now
Wesley Tsui (undergrad RA)	2026 – Now
Lai Avalos Mar (undergrad RA)	2026 – Now
Tanisha Chhabra (undergrad RA)	2026 – Now
Erica Dos Santos (undergrad RA; Work-Learn RA)	2025 – 2026
Esme Yang (undergrad RA; Work-Learn international RA)	2025 – 2026
Jadi Ng (undergrad RA)	2025 – 2026
Yucen Pang (Summer International MITACS student)	2026
Jeff Li (undergrad RA)	2025 – 2026
Sarah Galvin (undergrad RA)	2024 – 2025
Oniza Syed (Undergraduate Research Experience Program mentee)	2024 – 2025
Suri Zheng (Undergraduate Research Experience Program mentee)	2024 – 2025
Flora Zhang (Undergraduate Research Experience Program mentee)	2024 – 2025

University of Southern California

Romy Dolgin (summer undergrad RA)	2019
Michelle Wang (undergrad RA)	2019 – 2022
Clarice Szeto (undergrad RA)	2018 – 2020
Colleen Krogh (undergrad RA)	2018 – 2021
Rose Fajans (undergrad RA; honors student)	2020 – 2021
Cindy Qiu (undergrad RA)	2020 – 2021
Ann Tarry (undergrad RA)	2020 – 2021

Gillian Sawyer (undergrad RA)	2021
Ludi Yu (undergrad RA)	2021 – 2022
Veronica Yu (undergrad RA)	2021 – 2022
Mira Bhasin (undergrad RA)	2021 – 2023
Sammy Rush (undergrad RA)	2021 – 2023
Annika Baktha (undergrad RA)	2021 – 2024
Jaewon Cha (undergrad RA)	2022 – 2023
Mackenzie Forkas (undergrad RA)	2022 – 2023
Celine Wen (undergrad RA)	2022 – 2024
Naveen Haque (undergrad RA)	2022 – 2024
Tsugumi Kitayama (undergrad RA)	2022 – 2024
Deepali Yedulapuram (undergrad RA)	2023 – 2024
Precia Rhee (undergrad RA)	2023 – 2024
Rosela Pareyon (undergrad RA)	2023 – 2024
Fay Zhuozhuo Han (undergrad RA)	2023 – 2024
Landi Jiang (undergrad RA)	2024
Kira Giummo (undergrad RA)	2024

LARGE-SCALE COLLABORATIONS

ManyBabies 5: Hunter & Ames Model of Infant Looking Preference	2021 – present
Remote Infant Studies of Early Learning (RISE) Project	2025 – present
ManyBabies Exploration: Infant Habituation	2026

ACADEMIC SERVICES

Facilitator, Responsible Conduct of Research Course	2026 – Now
Faculty of Medicine, University of British Columbia (UBC and CITI Program hybrid course)	
Organizer, Developmental Area Speaker Series	2021 – 2022
Department of Psychology, University of Southern California	
Invited Panel Speaker	
USC Linguistics 610 Graduate Student Panel	2024
USC CLIMATE PhD Preview Day for Minority Students	2023
USC Psi Chi Graduate School Panel	2023
UCLA Chinese Students and Scholars Association Graduate School Panel	2018
Grant and Scholarship Reviewer	
SSHRC Canada Graduate Research Scholarships – Doctoral (2027 competition)	2026
Conference Reviewer	
UBC Language Sciences Postdoctoral & Graduate Research Day	2026
Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society	2024 – 2025
Budapest CEU Conference on Cognitive Development	2023 – 2024
California Meeting on Psycholinguistics	2021
Ad Hoc Journal Reviewer	
Cognition; Cognitive Development; Cognitive Psychology; Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience; Frontiers in Developmental Psychology; Language Learning and Development	

OUTREACH

Parents Time Online, Vancouver Public Library 2026
Invited public talk (upcoming, November 2026)

Early Childhood Educators of BC Annual Conference 2025
Workshop: Neuroscience of Early Brain Developments and Techniques to Support Neuronal Growth